

KIANA CHEATHAM

Designer-developer interested in UI/UX, 3D, and interactive media.

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EDUCATION

2029 Expected

University of California, Los Angeles (UCLA)

Design | Media Arts
Linguistics and Computer Science (pending)

2022 - 2024

Academy of Art University

Pre-college Art Experience Program:
Interaction & UI/UX Design
3D Creature and Character Modeling
VIS for Animation
Introduction to Animation

AWARDS & CERTIFICATIONS

2025

Congressional App Challenge Finalist

Created and developed an iOS app using Swift Playgrounds, emphasizing user experience design, interaction flow, and intuitive UI.

2024

NASA Student Art Contest - 3rd Place

2024

Entry Level Python Certification

2025

IBM AI Literacy Digital

ACTIVITIES

2026

ACM SIGGRAPH Student Volunteer

Supported conference operations and attendee experience. Gained exposure to cutting-edge computer graphics, animation, and interactive techniques.

2022 - 2025

CAD & Business Lead - Robotics Club

Member of all female Carlsbad High School Robotics team, Robopuffs. Led community outreach and education.

2022 - 2025

Vice President - Women in STEM Club

Carlsbad High School

2021 - 2025

Varsity Girls Water Polo & Swim Team

EXPERIENCE

2025 - Current

Projects Director / Design Dev Intern - ACM Design at UCLA

Manage projects for new team members. Previously worked on front and back-end development of a website supporting a UCLA student organization advocating for academic policies. Collaborate with designers and developers while using JavaScript, React, Tailwind CSS, HTML, CSS, and Figma. Create design assets and maintain consistent branding across club projects.

2026 - Current

UI Design Intern - Fitzi

Full app redesign for Fitzi, an AI-powered fashion app that lets users try on outfits virtually and share their looks. Collaborating with a small design team to develop a new, intuitive user interface in Figma, translating early concepts into polished, interactive screens.

2025 - Current

Digital Skills Instructor - EZ Beyond

Teach adults with developmental and learning disabilities in a dynamic learning environment: digital art, computer skills, coding, 3D modeling, math, and reading. Develop individualized lesson plans, adapt instruction to diverse learning needs, track student progress, and provide academic, behavioral, and emotional support.

2022 - 2024

Freelance Artist - Black Key Games

Created custom digital artwork for a board game using Procreate and Adobe InDesign. Collaborated with a Game Designer to research, create, and revise art. Artwork includes a variety of environmental backgrounds, characters and sci-fi weapons/tools.

2023

Engineering Intern - Moffat & Nichol

Selected to participate in a High School STEM summer program to explore Environmental Science and Engineering disciplines including case studies on dredging, wind farms, and construction for tsunamis. Continued mentorship with a CAD Specialist.

2023

Volunteer Artist - The Superhero Project

Collaborated with a nonprofit organization that uplifts hospitalized children by creating a custom superhero poster for a child impacted by serious illness or disability. Transformed the child's ideas into personalized digital artwork using Procreate.

2022

Freelance Artist - San Diego County

Created custom artwork for the 2022 "Shop with a Cop" holiday charity event benefiting underserved youth. Designed marketing materials, event posters, and T-shirts.

SKILLS

Procreate

Figma

Photoshop

Illustrator

InDesign

Blender

After Effects

SolidWorks

Fusion 360 CAD Design

Java

HTML and CSS

Swift

XCode

JavaScript

React